

Right Balmain bugs on sale in Sydney Fish Market – the second-largest in the world after Japan's Tsukiji market (see p246)

Below Juicy Balmain bugs, simply and quickly pan-fried with saffron



A Day in Sydney

Sydney is dominated by its iconic harbor, and the foreshore abounds with culture and commerce, from the cobbled lanes of the historic Rocks to the celebrated Opera House and the ferry hub of Circular Quay.

MORNING Walk around the forecourt of architect Joern Utzen's **Sydney Opera House** and gaze upon its concrete sails. Saunter around **Circular Quay** and take a guided tour, complete with hard hat and harness, up that other city icon, the **Harbour Bridge**.

AFTERNOON Follow the shoreline through the **Botanic Gardens** to **Mrs. Macquarie's Chair** and survey the harbor, then on to the **Andrew (Boy) Charlton**, a glamorous public pool that begs a dip. Drop into the **NSW Art Gallery** and its 11,000 works.

EVENING Hop on a ferry to **Taronga Zoo**, **Balmain**, or **Manly Beach**, just to ride it back again to see the sparkling city lights. Head up to **Australia Square** for a cocktail in the **Orbit Lounge Bar** on the 47th floor. It has 360-degree views and revolves – very slowly.

Essentials

GETTING THERE

Sydney Airport, 5 miles (8 km) from downtown, is served by major international airlines. **Rail** and **bus** services link airport and city.

WHERE TO STAY

The Kirketon (moderate) is an oasis in the lively Darlinghurst area. <http://kirketon.com.au>

Ravesi's (moderate) has a relaxed Bondi beachside vibe with a shot of chic. www.ravesis.com.au

Establishment Hotel (expensive) is a sleek place to indulge your rock-star fantasies. www.merivale.com/#/establishment/hotel

TOURIST INFORMATION

City Host Kiosks are at the Town Hall, George Street, and Circular Quay (corner of Pitt and Alfred Streets); www.visitnsw.com

